

Healthy Salt-Free Convection Oven Tandoori Chicken (20 Leg Pieces)

Ingredients

Chicken

- 20 chicken leg pieces

Main Marinade

- 2 cups thick curd / hung curd
- 3 tbsp ginger garlic paste
- Juice of 4 lemons
- 3 tbsp olive oil or mustard oil

Spices

- 4 tbsp Kashmiri chili powder
- 2 tsp turmeric powder
- 3 tbsp coriander powder
- 2 tbsp cumin powder
- 2 tbsp black pepper powder
- 2 tbsp paprika (optional)
- 2 tbsp garam masala
- 2 tbsp kasuri methi

Herbs

- 1 cup coriander leaves chopped
- 1/2 cup mint leaves chopped

No salt needed.

Step-by-Step Recipe

Step 1: Prepare Chicken

1. Wash chicken properly.
2. Drain water fully.
3. Pat dry using tissue or cloth.
4. Make 2–3 deep cuts on each leg piece.

Cuts help flavors enter deeply.

Step 2: Prepare Marinade

Take a large bowl and add:

- curd,
- ginger garlic paste,
- lemon juice,
- oil,
- all spice powders,
- kasuri methi,
- mint,
- coriander leaves.

Mix until smooth and thick.

Step 3: Marinate Chicken

1. Add chicken pieces.
2. Rub marinade deeply everywhere.
3. Push marinade into cuts also.

Marination Time

- Minimum:
2 hours
- Best:
Overnight in refrigerator

Long marination improves taste naturally even without salt.

Step 4: Preheat Oven

Oven Settings

- Mode:
Convection Bake
 - Temperature:
200°C
 - Preheat:
10–15 mins
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Step 5: Arrange Chicken

1. Place baking paper or foil on tray.
2. Arrange chicken with small gaps.
3. Use middle rack.

Do not overcrowd.

Step 6: Cook Chicken

First Bake

- 200°C
 - 25 mins
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Step 7: Flip

1. Remove tray carefully.
 2. Flip all pieces.
 3. Brush little leftover marinade lightly.
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Step 8: Second Bake

- 200°C
 - 20–25 mins
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Step 9: Final Light Browning

For light tandoori color:

- increase to 220°C
- bake only 2–3 mins

Do NOT heavily grill or blacken.

How to Check If Ready

Chicken is cooked when:

- juices run clear,
 - inside not pink,
 - outer layer reddish brown,
 - meat near bone cooks fully.
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Healthy Side Dishes

Serve with:

- onion rings,
 - cucumber,
 - carrot,
 - mint curd dip,
 - roasted vegetables,
 - sweet potato wedges.
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Optional Smoky Restaurant Flavor

Without burning:

1. Heat small charcoal piece till red.
2. Put small steel bowl inside cooked chicken tray.
3. Add charcoal into bowl.
4. Add few drops ghee.
5. Cover tray for 3 mins.

This gives smoky tandoori flavor naturally.

Approx Nutrition (Per Leg Piece)

- High protein
- Lower sodium
- Moderate healthy fats
- Very low carbs

Good for:

- fitness,
- muscle building,
- healthier eating,
- weight management.